

American Gov./ Economics





About the Course

Students spend a term learning the structure of our local and state governments, then turn to key primary source documents related to our government before ending the year with an introduction to economics, focusing on the history of money, the banking system, and personal finance.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

If a student hasn't studied the Constitution, consider having them take the 7th-grade government course first.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 1 time/week 30 min	Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (U.S.)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8



Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money



Reading PDF



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Grade 8 Reading PDF: State & Local Gov](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)

∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace* book.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Introduction to State & Local Government

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This term, we will learn about state and local governments. While we will focus on state and local government, we will sometimes reference the federal government to compare and contrast the state and local powers with federal powers.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.2-4

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

Origins of Authority: Constitutions & Police Powers

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

States have two sources of authority that allow them to create and enforce laws: 1) constitutional powers and 2) police powers. These sources of authority are the basis for the laws and regulations that states pass, as well as the authority that states grant to smaller local governments, like cities and towns.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.5-8

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 3 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

State Constitutions

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Last week, we explored sources of power for states. One of these sources is the state constitution. This week, you will familiarize yourself with your state's constitution.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.9

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 4

State Constitutions: The Preamble

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Although they do not have “legal effect,” the preamble to a constitution is an important statement. This week, you will examine your state constitution's preamble and consider its importance.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.10-13

→ REFLECT

Narrate. For your summary statement this week, analyze your state constitution's preamble as described in the Reading PDF on page 13.

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 5

State Government

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

Today, you will learn about your state government.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.14

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the questions about your state in your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 6

State Legislative Branch

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the legislative branch, and look up your state government representatives.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.15-18

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 7

State Executive Branch

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the executive branch and read about your state's governor.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.19

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 8

State Judicial Branch

📄 Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will review the sections of your state constitution that address the judicial branch and read about your state's highest court.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.20

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 9 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 9

Local Governments

📄 Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

You have read about the federal government and the state government. Today, you will look at local government. Local governments are a paradox because we most often forget that they exist, while they often have the most direct impact on our daily lives. This week, we will look at what they are and where local governments derive their authority (hint: it's not the Constitution).

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.21-24

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 10

Local Governments in Action

📄 Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you'll focus on how local governments impact our daily lives by reading some current events. Your Reading PDF includes several suggested articles, as well as tips for finding a good article about your local government.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF
p.25

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ REFLECT

Write a summary statement or draw a diagram describing the main ideas from the article you read.

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 11

Catch Up and Exploring Local Government Resources

Materials: Reading PDF

→ INTRO

This week, you will learn more about your local government.

→ NOTEBOOK

∞ Link: Reading PDF

p.26-27

Answer the questions about your town/county in your Citizenship Notebook.

WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Reading PDF

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 13

A Young Nation: American Government from 1800 to 1900

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Welcome back to American Government! Last year, you learned about the formation of the American Government and the reasoning behind why the Constitution and Bill of Rights were drafted and negotiated as they were. This year, we move forward to the period from 1800 to 1900 and study how the new government began to take action and shape the first hundred years of our country's history.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 1

- With any time that you have remaining, read your summary statements and skim any written narrations from the last two years of American Government. Your summary statements should cover the time periods from Rotation 1 (800-1650 AD) and Rotation 2 (1650-1800 AD).

→ REFLECT

Talk about the summary statements you have reviewed with your teacher or classmates. What did you remember? What had you forgotten? Did anything come to mind as you were reviewing that you had not thought about before?

★ TEACHER NOTE

One week is built in at the end of this term for “catch-up” reading, in case you miss a week or a reading takes you longer than your allotted time to complete. Please do not skip ahead if you have not completed the lesson from the week before – work through the weeks chronologically and use the catch-up week (Week 11) as necessary.

Optional Activity: Guide students in creating a bulleted list of keywords that they notice while reading their summary statements or during their discussion. Keywords can be words that were repeated frequently, or that stood out to the student for any particular reason (there is no “right” set of keywords). This activity is optional because it requires students to exercise a higher-level analysis and might not be a useful reflective tool for all students.

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 14

Western Expansion and the Missouri Compromise (1820)

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

The United States nearly doubled in size following the purchase of the Louisiana Territory from France. As new states began to petition Congress for entry to the country, the issue of slavery began to divide the nation. In 1820, Congress passed the Missouri Compromise, defining geographical boundaries that would determine whether slavery would be legal in new states. The Compromise would be followed by a series of legislative acts that together attempted to bind the new country together in the face of rapid land expansion and deep divides over slavery.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 2

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 15

Western Expansion and the Compromise of 1850

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Although the Missouri Compromise remained in effect, the acquisition of the western territory from Texas to modern-day California following the Mexican-American War reignited the question of whether new states formed from this territory would be admitted as slave states or free states. In order to maintain a tentative balance of slave to free states across the nation, Congress passed the Compromise of 1850 after efforts to ban slavery entirely from the new territory failed.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 3

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 16

Western Expansion and the Kansas-Nebraska Act

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

The Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854 repealed the Missouri Compromise in its entirety and allowed the new territories of Kansas and Nebraska to decide the question of whether slavery would be allowed in the territories by popular sovereignty – by a vote of the people of the territories. Violence stemming from pro-slavery and abolitionist clashes in Kansas and in Washington, D.C., earned the nickname “Bleeding Kansas” and foreshadowed the start of the Civil War.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 4

→ REFLECT

Consider the three major pieces of Congressional legislation that you have studied over the last three weeks: the Missouri Compromise, the Compromise of 1850, and the Kansas-Nebraska Act. Why do you think that Representatives and Senators in Congress increasingly decided to turn the slavery question over to popular vote? What benefits are there to a popular vote? What drawbacks or dangers might there be to a popular vote?

- Write a summary statement or short narration explaining your thoughts in response to these questions.

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 17

Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part I)

Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

Treaties are a tool that the Constitution allows the President to use in order to make formal agreements between the United States and another

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

nation. Over the first four decades of the 19th century, the United States began to engage in treaty-making with American Indian Tribes, located in what are now the southern states of Tennessee, Alabama, Georgia, Florida, and Mississippi, with the goal of removing these Tribes from the South and relocating them west of the Mississippi River.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 5

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 18 *Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part II)*

 Materials: Reading PDF Part 1

→ INTRO

With the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Congress indicated its support for the removal of tribes, specifically authorizing then-President Andrew Jackson to use treaties to effect land exchanges, trading land west of the Mississippi to tribes in exchange for tribal land in the South. But was the Indian Removal Act constitutional, and were the treaties themselves enforceable? We will explore the Act and its impact further in this week's reading.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 1
Week 6

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 19 *Tribal Nations before the Supreme Court*

 Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

While President Jackson and Congress worked to remove Tribes from the South by means of treaties and federal legislation, the Cherokee Nation sought to enforce its treaty rights before the Supreme Court. Over the course of two decisions within the span of the same number of years, the Supreme Court set precedent that would define the rights and status of Tribes into the modern day, and by extension, undermined the integrity of the federal government's treaty-making with these Tribes. The Indian Appropriations Act, passed in 1871 by Congress, would end treaty-making with Tribes altogether.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 7

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 20 *Congress & Southern Secession*

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

On December 20, 1860, South Carolina seceded from the United States. Over the next seven months, ten more states would follow suit. Four of these states drafted formal Declarations of Causes that set forth their justifications for secession. This week, we will explore these Declarations in more detail and consider the impact that southern secession had on the federal Congress the states left behind.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 8

→ REFLECT

Consider how the various southern secession documents compare or contrast with the Declaration of Independence. What strikes you as similar or different? Among other things, you want to think about the organization or length of the documents, the reasons given for separation, and the historical events occurring at the time that each document was signed.

- Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you have a group of students, pose this question for group discussion as an alternative to traditional narration. If you are the only student in your class, jot down some of the similarities or differences that you think of.

WEEK 9 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 21 *Congress & the Reconstruction Acts*

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

Following the end of the Civil War and preliminary reconstruction efforts by President Johnson, Congress exerted control over the Reconstruction project by passing a series of acts now known as the Reconstruction Acts. These Acts, passed over a presidential veto by Johnson, established military control in southern states that had seceded and established strict standards for readmission to the Union.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 9

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 22 *"Defective from the Start": The Constitution, Slavery, & the Civil War Amendments*

Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ INTRO

In addition to taking control of Reconstruction following the close of the Civil War, Congress also proposed three amendments to the Constitution. These amendments, now known as the Civil War Amendments, banned slavery and established a series of protections and rights that are now

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

foundational to how we think about citizenship in the United States. It would be five years before these amendments were fully ratified by the states, and it would be nearly a hundred more years until the Civil Rights Movement would take up the vision for justice and equality that these amendments had begun to advance.

→ READ

∞ Link: Reading PDF Part 2
Week 10

→ REFLECT

Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 23

Catch-Up Day

 Materials: Reading PDF Part 2

→ CATCH UP

Catch up on any reading you have not completed for this term.
Review your summary statements in chronological order so that you have a complete picture of how our readings relate to each other.

WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Reading PDF

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the Bible verse, "The love of money is a root of all kinds of evil" (1 Timothy 6:10)? What do you think that means, and how have you seen that truth play out? This term, we will be studying economics, which has to do with money and the way a country uses and produces goods and services.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Introduction ix-xiii "Bread. Dough." - "dollars and cents."
2. p.8 "You've Got It and I Want It: The Law of Supply and Demand"

- How does money help the economy, and how does greed hurt the economy?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: What is Supply and Demand?

- Explain the economic principle "The Law of Supply and Demand."

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK (MAKE A SECTION IN YOUR NOTEBOOK OR BINDER CALLED ECONOMICS)

1. Make a list of the goods and services your family uses that contribute toward a healthy economy. Goods are tangible things you buy, such as clothes and food. Services are intangible and usually involve paying for a business to do something for you. Examples: haircuts, car insurance, phone service.
2. Can you think of examples that fit the economic principle of the Law of Supply and Demand? Also, make a list of items that may be in high demand or low demand depending on the time of year.

WEEK 2 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.1-9 "Have you ever" - "the ancient world."

- Why did the bartering system need to be replaced with something better?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

- ∞ Image Link: Cowrie shells (used as money in ancient China)
- ∞ Image Link: Deerskin used as folding money (China)
- ∞ Image Link: Chinese paper money
- ∞ Image Link: Fort Knox

- Talk about the different items used before money and why they didn't work out.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a timeline and draw pictures with labels to show the different

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

mediums of exchange from ancient times to the present day. Look at p.4-5 to help you fill out the timeline. There are links to see some of the different mediums that were used.

WEEK 3 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 27

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World

- On p.8, find Mesopotamia and Babylon. What present-day countries are located there?
- On p.30-31, find Jerusalem, Edessa, Antioch, and Tripoli. Now, find Florence, Italy. These are places that we will read about today that have to do with an early form of banking.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.2 p.11-19 "Where do you keep" - "Hard work."
2. p.12 "An Eye for an Eye"
3. p.14 "You Can't Take it With You"

- What banking practices from history are still used today?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Image Link: The Knights Templar

- How did the Knights Templar help the Pilgrims while traveling to Jerusalem?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Founding of the order the Knights Templar (1119 AD)

WEEK 4 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.3 p.21-29 "In early America" - "finally in place."
2. p.22 "Financial Genius: Alexander Hamilton"

- What were some reasons some people were opposed to a national bank?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the map on p.27, which shows the locations of Federal Reserve Banks. What bank is your city part of? You can check out this link to see the 12 districts.

Image Link: The Twelve Federal Reserve Districts

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a chart showing the information on p.28. You can look at these websites to find additional information, such as the names of the people in charge of the different areas.

Link: Federal Reserve Board

Link: Comptroller of the Currency

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this 3-minute video on this website that explains the purpose of the Federal Reserve System.

Video Link: Purpose of Federal Reserve System

• IMPORTANT DATES

Establishment of the first national bank of the United States (1791)

The Federal Reserve Banks were established (1913)

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

PREP: Print out the check template and check register.

∞ Link: Check template

∞ Link: Check register

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.31-41 "Money and power" - "always that way."

- What happens when you write a check for more than you have in your bank account?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Explain the graph on p.39. It is based on the idea that you have \$1000 in a savings account.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

1. Fill out the check template and check register (bank book), and put it in your notebook.
2. Make a list of the types of bank accounts and briefly describe each one. See p.40 for more information.

WEEK 6 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 30

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the stock market? What do you know about it?

Before reading chapter 5, please read the section on p.45, "Companies for Sale," to prepare for the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.44-49 "Inflation. Recession." - "had to be done."

- Describe some of the events that led to the Great Depression

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Stock Market Crash (1929)

WEEK 7 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 31

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

What do you think it would be like to become the President in the middle of the Great Depression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.49-53 "Franklin Delano Roosevelt" - "and cannot work."

(You don't need to read the excerpt "Thinking about Money" on p.52. It will be read in the next lesson.)

• EXTRA HELPING

You can look to see what public works were created in your state as a result of the New Deal which employed thousands of people.
∞ Link: New Deal projects by state

• IMPORTANT DATES

New Deal programs are established by FDR (1933)

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- What are some things that President Roosevelt did to help the economy? Why did some people not agree with those actions?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the economic programs that were part of the New Deal. You can find the information on p.53 and at the following website.
∞ Link: New Deal Programs

WEEK 8 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know what a mortgage is? How does it help people buy houses?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.55-61 "Most people" - "in the future."

- Explain what we mean by a housing bubble and how that was one of the factors that led to the Great Recession.
- On p.61, the author writes, "Once again, Keynesian economics came into play as the US government stepped in to institute large and controversial programs." Go back to p.52 and read the excerpt about the famous economist John Maynard Keynes. Discuss his theories and how they came into play during the Great Recession.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the ways the government stepped in to stimulate the economy during the Great Recession. You can find information in the excerpts on p.60-61.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Great Recession (December 2007-June 2009)

WEEK 9 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 33

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

What would life be like if everyone only bought things they could afford in cash? How could that be a good thing? How could that be a negative thing? What items might be hard to purchase?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.63-71 "In the first" - "need to do."

- What are the pros and cons of using credit cards?
- What factors affect one's credit score?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the different kinds of real estate loans and include a brief description of each.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Why do you think having a budget is a wise financial practice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.73-76 "Money is - "manage your money."

- What is the difference between needs and wants, and how does that affect a budget?
- Many people suggest three categories for budgeting: spending, saving, and giving. What do you think about those 3 categories, and how can you go about implementing that?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Practice putting together a budget. Use the example on p.74 and create a chart in your notebook. If you don't have your own money or expenses, you can try to put one together to show the expenses of an average household and see what kind of income you would need to cover those expenses.

WEEK 11 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 35

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Citizenship notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know how much debt the U.S. has? Take a guess. You can find the answer on this website:

∞ Link: National Debt

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Ch.8 p.77-83
2. p.78 "The National Debt"
3. p.82 "Getting Down to Basics" and "The Hammer"
4. Conclusion p.85-86

- Why do you think it is so hard to balance the national budget?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the items that the federal government spends money on. Make a list of ways the government receives money (revenue). Try brainstorming on your own, and then use these websites to find more information.

∞ Link: Government Spending

∞ Link: Sources of Federal Revenue

WEEK 12 30m American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 36

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

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Term 3

Questions will come from:
Dollars & Sense

American Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

Examination

- Term 1** · Reading PDF: Describe your state government as it is created by your state constitution. Include 1) what the different branches are, 2) the powers that the different branches have, and 3) if your constitution had a preamble, what problems or goals the preamble tried to address. OR Describe the differences between the federal government, your state government, and your local government.
- Term 2** · Reading PDF: Tell about the expansion of the United States into the Southeast and the relocation of Tribal Nations. What actions did Congress, the President, and/or the Supreme Court take with regard to Removal? How did tribes respond to Removal efforts?
OR
Tell about reconstruction following the Civil War. Consider how the three branches of the federal government addressed reconstruction. What attitude and actions did President Johnson take with regard to reintegration of Southern states? What were some of the actions that Congress took? Bonus: What did the Supreme Court have to say about the 14th's Amendment's promise of equality, first in the 1800s and now in 2026?
- Term 3** · Dollars & Sense: Tell what you know about the formation of the national banking system OR Tell what you know about the services banks offer.